

CLAT Express - January 2026: Answer Key

Multiple-choice passages

Strike and Legal Debate

1	C. FARC	The booklet states the US alleges Cartel of the Suns collaborated with FARC to traffic cocaine.
2	D. Three	The booklet lists three core principles: non-colonisation, non-intervention and US non-interference in Europe.
3	C. I and II only	Statements I and II are stated in the booklet, while III is the opposite of its non-colonisation principle.
4	A. I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B	The Monroe Doctrine was proclaimed in 1823, the Roosevelt Corollary came in 1904, Maduro's second term began in January 2019, and Guaido cited Articles 233 and 333.
5	C. 300	The booklet estimates Venezuela's proven crude oil reserves at over 300 billion barrels.
6	D. A is false but R is true	The Roosevelt Corollary justified US intervention, not European intervention, so A is false while R is true.
7	B. Only two	Statements I and II match the booklet, while III is wrong because NATO, AU and ECOWAS intervene without UNSC approval.
8	A. Head of National Assembly	The booklet identifies Juan Guaido as Head of the National Assembly when he declared himself Acting President.

Greenland's Status: Practice Set

1	D. Kaffeklubben Island	The booklet recognises Kaffeklubben Island as the world's northernmost point of land.
2	C. A is true but R is false	The GIUK Gap stands for Greenland, Iceland and United Kingdom, not Ireland, and it is a key chokepoint for monitoring naval movements.
3	A. I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A	Pituffik was formerly Thule Air Base, the 1946 proposal was a \$100 million purchase offer, the 1951 agreement covered military access, and rare earths are crucial for semiconductors and defence systems.
4	B. Only two	Statements I and II are correct, while the US purchase proposal was made in 1946, not 1951.
5	D. I and III only	Statement I and III are correct, while the Anti-Coercion Instrument is primarily a deterrent tool rather than a military one.
6	A. Trade Bazooka	The booklet calls the Anti-Coercion Instrument the 'Trade Bazooka'.
7	C. North Atlantic Council	The booklet says the North Atlantic Council, NATO's principal political decision-making body, takes any decision to invite a country to join.
8	D. Both I and II	Both statements appear in the booklet's NATO section: the Article 5 provision and the 1949 founding by 12 countries.

Board of Peace: structure and purpose

1	C. Resolution 2803 (2025)	The booklet states that the Board is established under UN Security Council Resolution 2803 (2025).
2	D. 13	The booklet states that the charter contains 13 Articles covering membership, financial contributions and dispute redressal.

3	D. Only if he resigns voluntarily or is unanimously declared incapable by the Executive Board	The booklet says the chairman can be removed only if he resigns voluntarily or is unanimously declared incapable by the Executive Board.
4	C. I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A	Mladenov is High Representative, Ali Shaath chairs the NCAG, the initial authorisation lasts until 31 December 2027, and the charter has 13 Articles.
5	B. I and III only	Statements I and III are correct, while the chairman is US President Donald Trump, not the Secretary of State.
6	C. Only three	Statements 1, 2 and 4 are correct, while statement 3 is wrong because the plan states that Israel won't occupy Gaza.
7	A. Only statement 1 is correct	Membership requires consent to be bound by the Charter, and the Gaza Executive Board includes no Palestinian representative.

Chagos Dispute Check

1	D. 1965	The UK declared the Chagos Islands a British Indian Ocean Territory in 1965, before Mauritius became independent in 1968.
2	C. 1968-1973	Between 1968 and 1973, the UK and US forcibly removed native Chagossians to make way for the military base.
3	C. UN Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS)	The Permanent Court of Arbitration ruled that the UK violated Mauritius' rights under UNCLOS.
4	B. I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C	The Marine Protected Area dates to 2010, PCA proceedings to 2015, the UNGA vote to 2017 and the ICJ order to 2019.
5	C. I and III only	Statement II is wrong because Mauritius gained independence in 1968, while statements I and III match the booklet.
6	B. Only two	Statements I and III are correct, while statement II is wrong because the UNGA vote was in 2017, not 2015.
7	D. 2017	The UNGA voted on Mauritius' resolution to seek an ICJ advisory opinion in 2017.

UAE-Saudi rift: practice set

1	D. Ali Abdullah Saleh	Ali Abdullah Saleh, who had governed North Yemen since 1978, became president of the unified state.
2	D. Sanaa	The booklet lists Sana'a as Yemen's capital, currently under Houthi control.
3	C. Counter-terrorism operations	The UAE reiterated that its military presence is confined to counter-terrorism operations, not broader political or factional conflicts.
4	C. I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A	The STC advocates autonomy since 2017, Al-Hirak formed in 2007, the Houthis come from northern Zaydi Shia, and AQAP captured southern and eastern territory.
5	B. I and III only	The two states merged in 1990, not 1994, so statement II is incorrect while I and III are correct.
6	B. Only two	Statements I and III are correct, while the UAE described its mandate as counter-terrorism, not political mediation.
7	D. Houthi movement	The Houthi movement is officially known as Ansar Allah.

Republic Day Chronology and History

1	A. Ursula von der Leyen and Antonio Costa	The text names Ursula von der Leyen and Antonio Costa as the Chief Guests for Republic Day 2026.
2	A. 131	The text states that 131 honours were conferred under the Padma Awards 2026.

3	B. Ashok Chakra	The text says Shubhanshu Shukla was honoured with the Ashok Chakra, India's highest peacetime gallantry award.
4	B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A	Both statements are true, but the 1950 institution of Wartime Gallantry does not explain why awards are announced twice a year.
5	C. I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C	Parakram Divas is 23 January, Beating Retreat is 29 January, Constitution Day is 26 November and the Amar Jawan Jyoti homage is on 26 January.
6	D. I and II only	Statement III is wrong because Gallantry Awards are announced twice a year, while I and II match the text.
7	B. Only two	The President, not the Prime Minister, unfurls the flag on Republic Day, so only two statements are correct.
8	A. 26 January 1930	The text states the Declaration of Independence was officially promulgated on 26 January 1930.

Equity Regulations: Provisions and Checks

1	C. 15 working days	The Equity Committee must submit its inquiry report within 15 working days.
2	A. 3	The Equity Committee has 3 senior faculty members among its other members.
3	D. SC, ST, OBC, women and persons with disabilities	The representation requirements name SC, ST, OBC, women and persons with disabilities.
4	B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A	Both statements are true, but the chairperson role does not explain the 24-hour convening rule.
5	C. I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B	The convening rule is 24 hours, the inquiry report is 15 working days, two student representatives sit on the committee, and the National Monitoring Committee meets at least twice a year.
6	A. I and III only	Statement II is wrong because Ombudsperson decisions are binding, while statements I and III match the text.
7	B. Only two	Statements I and III are correct, while the Ombudsperson is an independent authority outside the Equity Committee.
8	D. Neither I nor II	The inquiry period is 15 working days and the National Monitoring Committee meets at least twice a year, so both statements are wrong.

Incubation Schemes Check

1	A. Gen-Next Support for Innovative Startups	GENESIS stands for Gen-Next Support for Innovative Startups.
2	D. I and III only	GENESIS is aimed at Tier-II and Tier-III cities, so statement II is wrong while I and III match the booklet.
3	C. NITI Aayog	The booklet states that the Atal Innovation Mission operates under NITI Aayog.
4	A. ASPIRE	ASPIRE sets up a network of technology centres and incubation centres and promotes startups in agro-industry.
5	B. I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C	GENESIS targets Tier-II and Tier-III cities, ASPIRE builds centre networks for agro-industry, NIDHI turns technology ideas into startups and TIDE 2.0 supports emerging technologies.
6	B. Only two	GENESIS is the 2024 scheme, so only statements I and III are correct.
7	D. NIDHI	NIDHI aims at socio-economic growth through wealth and job creation.

India-EU FTA: CLAT Practice

1	C. \$136.53 billion	Bilateral trade in 2024-25 was \$136.53 billion, of which India's exports were \$75.85 billion.
2	A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	The booklet states that the EU's 99.5% duty elimination brings labour-intensive sectors such as textiles to 0% duty, which explains the expected gain.
3	D. I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C	The EU removes duties on 99.5% of Indian exports, car tariffs decline from 110%, the car quota is 250,000 units, and machinery tariffs are up to 44%.
4	B. I and III only	Dairy, wheat, rice and poultry remain outside India's tariff reduction framework, so statement II is false while I and III are correct.
5	C. Only two	Statements I and III are correct, while textiles are not in the CBAM sector list, so statement II is wrong.
6	A. 27	The European Commission is composed of 27 Commissioners, one from each member state.
7	B. European Parliament	The European Parliament is the EU's only elected legislative body and is elected every five years.
8	D. 1 January 2026	CBAM moved to full implementation with a carbon levy payable on imports from 1 January 2026.

Birth Control Policy in China

1	A. 1958-1962	The Great Leap Forward ran from 1958 to 1962 and aimed to boost production and living standards.
2	C. Later, Longer, Fewer	The slogan 'Later, Longer, Fewer' encouraged delayed marriages, longer intervals between births and fewer children.
3	B. I-C, II-A, III-D, IV-B	The Great Leap Forward resulted in famine, the slogan encouraged delayed marriage, the One-Child Policy restricted couples to one child, and the Three-Child Policy relaxed limits.
4	D. I and II only	Statement III is wrong because the Three-Child Policy came in 2021, while 2016 marked the Two-Child Policy.
5	B. Only two	Statements I and III are correct, while II is wrong because the One-Child Policy was formally introduced in 1980.
6	A. I only	Statement II is wrong because population growth rebounded only after the Great Leap Forward was rolled back.

BBNJ and the law of the seas

1	C. 83	The text states that the BBNJ Agreement has been ratified by 83 countries.
2	A. Signed, ratification pending	The text says India has signed the agreement and its ratification is pending.
3	D. A is false but R is true	Full sovereignty applies to the territorial sea, while the high seas are free for navigation by vessels of all nations.
4	A. I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C	The BBNJ Agreement was adopted in 2023, has 83 ratifications, targets 30% protection by 2030 and has four pillars.
5	C. I and III only	Statement I and statement III are correct, while India has only signed the agreement with ratification pending.
6	B. Only two	Statements I and II are correct, since the agreement has four pillars and India's ratification is still pending.
7	D. Climate Change Mitigation	The four pillars are marine genetic resources, area-based management tools, environmental impact assessments, and capacity building and technology transfer.

8	A. 30% of land and sea by 2030	The text states the Kunming-Montreal framework targets 30% protection of land and sea by 2030.
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PSLV-C62 mission check

1	B. 8 months	The booklet states the PSLV-C62 failure followed the PSLV-C61 setback in 8 months.
2	C. DRDO	EOS-N1 (Anvesha) was developed for DRDO's Strategic Applications.
3	A. I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B	Anvesha is a hyperspectral imaging satellite, KID is a re-entry prototype, AayulSAT is a refuelling payload, and Vikas is the second-stage liquid engine.
4	A. I and III only	Statement II is wrong because the booklet says solid propellants are used in the first and third stages.
5	B. Only two	Statements A and D are correct, while B (KID is from a Spanish startup) and C (104 satellites was a 2017 record) are wrong.
6	A. PSLV-C57	Aditya-L1 was aboard PSLV-C57 on 2 September 2023, while PSLV-C58 carried XPoSat.
7	D. OrbitAID Aerospace	AayulSAT was developed by OrbitAID Aerospace, a Bengaluru-based company.

Governance Act practice set

1	B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A	Both statements are in the text, but the tribunal's head does not explain why its appeals lie only to the Supreme Court.
2	A. I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A	Each body matches its own fact: the NOC with Olympic sports, the NPC with Paralympic sports, the CAS with 1984 and the NADA with 2005.
3	B. I and II only	Statements I and II are in the text, whereas the appellate authority is the Supreme Court only, so III is wrong.
4	B. Only two	The committee's secretary member comes from the Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports, not Finance, so only I and II are correct.
5	C. 4	The Rules require at least 4 Sportspersons of Outstanding Merit, aged 25 or more, in the General Body.
6	D. 2005	The National Anti-Doping Agency was set up in 2005 under the Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports.
7	B. Aman Sehrawat	Aman Sehrawat won a bronze at the 2024 Paris Olympics as the youngest Indian individual Olympic medallist.
8	A. 2	The Tribunal has 2 other members, experts in sports, public administration or law, besides its head.

UN and Control Regimes Check

1	B. I only	North Korea withdrew from the NPT in 2003, so only statement I is correct.
2	B. I and II only	Statement III is wrong because the Wassenaar Arrangement (1996) came after the MTCR (1987).
3	A. A is false but R is true	The booklet describes the Australia Group as an informal arrangement that is not legally binding.
4	C. Only two	Statements I and III are correct, II is wrong because the General Assembly elects non-permanent members, and IV is wrong because Italy, Spain and others are the prime movers.

5	D. I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B	NSG regulates nuclear-related exports, MTCR covers missile and drone technology, Wassenaar controls conventional arms and dual-use goods, and the NPT classifies states by their 1967 nuclear status.
6	C. 2018	The booklet notes that India joined the Australia Group in 2018.
7	D. Italy	Italy is listed among the prime movers of the Coffee Club, which opposes expansion of permanent seats.
8	A. 1996	The booklet dates the Wassenaar Arrangement to 1996.

Type-in-the-answer passages

Crisis and Sanctions Recall

1	PDVSA	The booklet says US sanctions targeted PDVSA (Petroleos de Venezuela, S.A.) to cut off Maduro's oil revenue.
2	2018	The booklet identifies the 2018 presidential elections as widely criticised as unfair and non-transparent.
3	Bolivar	The booklet's country profile lists the Venezuelan Bolivar as the currency.
4	Usurper	The booklet says the National Assembly rejected the election results and called Maduro a 'Usurper'.
5	2019	The booklet states Maduro was sworn in for a controversial second term in January 2019.
6	1823	The booklet gives the Monroe Doctrine as proclaimed in 1823.

Minerals and Arctic Routes: Typed Answers

1	China	The booklet describes the rare earth elements market as China-dominated.
2	Transpolar Sea Route	The booklet names the Transpolar Sea Route as an emerging route opened by melting Arctic ice.
3	Panama	The booklet says new Arctic routes could bypass the Panama Canal and Suez Canal.
4	Near-Arctic State	The booklet states that China labels itself a 'Near-Arctic State'.
5	GIUK	The booklet explains that GIUK stands for Greenland, Iceland and United Kingdom.
6	Thule Air Base	The booklet says Pituffik Space Base was formerly known as Thule Air Base.

Membership and Gaza governance bodies

1	Nickolay Mladenov	The booklet names Bulgarian diplomat Nickolay Mladenov as High Representative for Gaza and on-the-ground liaison.
2	Ali Shaath	The NCAG is chaired by Ali Shaath, a former Palestinian Authority Deputy Minister.
3	15	The NCAG is described as a 15-member committee of politically independent Palestinian technocrats.
4	8	The listed members are the US, UK, Turkey, Qatar, Egypt, UAE, Cyprus and Netherlands, which is eight countries.
5	3	Rotational membership has a 3-year tenure without mandatory financial contribution.
6	1	Permanent membership is available through a reported contribution of USD 1 billion.

7	2027	The Board's initial authorisation lasts until 31 December 2027.
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India-Mauritius Recall

1	1948	India and Mauritius established diplomatic relations in 1948.
2	1901	Mahatma Gandhi visited Mauritius in 1901.
3	1987	The Indira Gandhi Centre for Indian Culture was established in 1987 and is India's largest cultural centre abroad.
4	Singapore	Mauritius was the second largest source of FDI into India in FY 2024-25, after Singapore.
5	887.25	Bilateral trade between India and Mauritius in FY 2024-25 was USD 887.25 million.
6	Agaléga	India upgraded the Agaléga Island airstrip into a full-length airfield.
7	2021	The Comprehensive Economic Cooperation and Partnership Agreement between India and Mauritius was signed in 2021.

Yemen's divide and Houthi rise: short answers

1	1990	The two Yemeni states merged in 1990 to form the Republic of Yemen.
2	1994	Southern leaders attempted secession in 1994, leading to a brief civil conflict.
3	2007	The Southern Movement (Al-Hirak) formed in 2007.
4	Hussein al-Houthi	Hussein al-Houthi, the movement's founder, was killed by Yemeni forces in Saada in 2004.
5	2014	The Houthis seized Saada and captured Sanaa in 2014, and Hadi fled abroad in 2015.
6	Bab al Mandeb	In 2015 the Houthis expanded control in western Yemen, including the Bab al Mandeb Strait.
7	Ali Abdullah Saleh	The Houthis later killed Ali Abdullah Saleh in 2017 for switching allegiance to the Saudi-led coalition.

Awards and Honours Recall

1	1952	The text states that peacetime gallantry awards were instituted in 1952.
2	5	The text lists 5 Padma Vibhushan awardees among the 131 Padma honours.
3	70	The text says Gallantry Awards were conferred on 70 armed forces personnel.
4	Ashoka Chakra	The text describes the Ashok Chakra as India's highest peacetime gallantry award.
5	Shubhanshu Shukla	The text says Shubhanshu Shukla, the first Indian on the ISS, was honoured with the Ashok Chakra.
6	2015	The text states that 26 November has been observed as Constitution Day since 2015.
7	Ursula von der Leyen	The text names Ursula von der Leyen, President of the European Commission, as a Chief Guest.

Caste Discrimination and Safeguards

1	118	UGC reported a 118% rise, from 173 complaints in 2019-20 to 378 in 2023-24.
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2	108	Pending cases rose from 18 in 2019-20 to 108 in 2023-24 despite high disposal rates.
3	173	UGC data show 173 complaints in 2019-20, rising to 378 in 2023-24.
4	2016	The Rohith Vemula case is dated 2016 in the booklet.
5	46	Article 46 directs the promotion of educational and economic interests of weaker sections.
6	1955	The Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955 imposes penalties for practising untouchability.
7	1989	The SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 enforces strict punishments against exploitation.

Funding Schemes Recall

1	June 2016	The Fund of Funds for Startups was introduced in June 2016.
2	10,000	The Fund of Funds for Startups has a corpus of 10,000 crore.
3	16 January	The booklet says National Startup Day is observed on 16 January, the date the Startup India Initiative was launched.
4	Seed Fund Scheme	The Startup India Seed Fund Scheme provides assistance for proof of concept and prototype development.
5	Incubators	Seed fund assistance is delivered through eligible incubators.
6	Domestic capital	The Fund of Funds aims to enhance access to domestic capital.

Tariffs and Market Access: Quick Recall

1	99.5	The EU will eliminate customs duties on 99.5% of Indian exports.
2	10	The tariff on these cars declines from 110% to 10% over five years.
3	250,000	The agreement sets a tariff rate quota of 250,000 units per year for these cars.
4	44	India's tariffs on machinery are as high as 44%, and these will be phased out for EU goods.
5	4	India's tariff phase-out offers EU exporters savings of approximately EUR 4 billion annually.
6	Champagne	The parallel GI agreement protects Darjeeling Tea and Champagne from unauthorised use or imitation.
7	2004	The India-EU relationship was upgraded to a Strategic Partnership at The Hague Summit in 2004.

Global and Indian Fertility Context

1	8.2	The booklet gives the current world population as 8.2 billion.
2	2050	Global TFR was 2.25 in 2024 and is projected to hit replacement level of 2.1 by 2050.
3	1.9	India's fertility rate in 2025 was 1.9, below the replacement level of 2.1.
4	Bihar	Bihar (2.98) is listed first among the above-replacement states, ahead of Meghalaya, UP, Jharkhand and Manipur.
5	68	The booklet states that 68% of India's population is of working age (15-64 years).
6	1987	UNFPA was founded in 1969 as the UN Fund for Population Activities and renamed in 1987.
7	21	The proposal aims to raise the legal age of marriage for girls to 21 years.

UNCLOS and ocean zones

1	168	The text states that UNCLOS has 168 parties.
2	3	The text says the Convention created three new institutions at the international level.
3	200	The text gives the Exclusive Economic Zone as 200 NM.
4	International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea	The International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea is an independent judicial body with jurisdiction over such disputes.
5	83	The booklet states that the BBNJ Agreement has been ratified by 83 countries; India's ratification is pending.
6	1.852	The text defines 1 nautical mile as 1.852 km.

PSLV profile recall

1	104	The booklet records 104 satellites in one PSLV launch in 2017.
2	1994	PSLV achieved its first success in 1994 with the IRS-P2 satellite.
3	IRS-P2	The first success in 1994 was the insertion of the IRS-P2 remote sensing satellite.
4	1750	PSLV can carry up to 1750 kg to a 600 km Sun-synchronous orbit.
5	Vikas	The booklet identifies the Vikas engine as the liquid-propellant second stage of PSLV.
6	PSLV-C57	Aditya-L1 was launched aboard PSLV-C57 on 2 September 2023.
7	2008	The booklet lists Chandrayaan-1 as a 2008 mission that verified the presence of water on the Moon.

Anti-doping and performance recall

1	1984	The Court of Arbitration for Sport was set up in 1984 by the International Olympic Committee.
2	PT Usha	PT Usha is named as the President of the Indian Olympic Association.
3	6	India won 6 medals at Paris, made up of 1 silver and 5 bronze.
4	71	India placed 71st in the Paris Olympics medals tally.
5	191	The UNESCO convention is recorded with 191 countries, including India.
6	2019	The Fit India Movement was launched in 2019 to encourage mass participation in fitness.
7	Gukesh	D Gukesh became the world's youngest chess champion at 18 by beating Ding Liren at the 2024 FIDE World Chess Championship.

Economy and Rankings Check

1	40	The business ecosystem pillar carries a 40 per cent weight, the largest of the four pillars.
2	192	The booklet states that Singapore retained the top position with access to 192 countries.
3	South Korea	The booklet says Japan and South Korea are tied for second place.
4	2014	The booklet says food prices entered deflation at -0.2% for the first time since 2014.
5	2027	The booklet projects India to surpass Germany by 2027.
6	136	The booklet gives India's per capita nominal GDP as \$2,820, ranked 136th.

7	Maharashtra	Maharashtra is listed first among the large-state leaders, followed by Tamil Nadu and Gujarat.
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